

Application Guidelines

For April 2026

for IAESTE Internship



Application period: **Wednesday 1 April – Friday 24 April 2026, 15:00**

Please note that there are restrictions for April applications as underlined.

Eligibility: at least a third-year undergraduate student at the start of internship and enrolled in a Japanese IAESTE member university or graduate school (see p.7) till the end of the internship as well (regardless of nationality).

Internship period: Internship is available between June 1, 2026 and May 31, 2027.

If you wish an internship after June 2027, please apply in September 2026.

This guideline is intended to outline IAESTE and its internship programs and the application process for those who are interested in applying for IAESTE internship. Please refer to the Internship Candidate Manual if you would like to know more about the procedures and precautions to be taken after you have applied and obtained the right to become an intern.

IAESTE JAPAN

Contents

I. About IAESTE

1. What is IAESTE	2
2. Glossary	2
3. Exchange system and matching	4
4. The two types of offers and their characteristics Exchange Internship/Global Internship	4
5. IAESTE Member Countries	5
6. Trends in exchange numbers	5

II. Overview of IAESTE Internships

1. Field of internship	6
2. Destination	6
3. Duration of internship	6
4. Accommodation	6
5. Language	6
6. Amount to be paid to IAESTE Office	6
7. Costs of internship	7
8. Requirements set by the host organization, etc.	7

III. Flow up to the internship confirmation

8

IV. List of fields of internship

9

Contents of the Internship Candidate Manual

I. Procedures after approval as an intern candidate.	2
II. Matching	3
III. Submitting the nomination documents	4
IV. Acceptance/rejection decisions of the host institution and procedures after the decision to accept	6
V. Preliminary procedures and preparations	7
VI. From pre-departure to end of internship	8
VII. In case that the internship is not implemented	9

I. About IAESTE

1. What is IAESTE?

IAESTE is an international non-governmental organization that promotes internships abroad in a wide variety of professional fields, mainly in **STEM fields**, but also in management, marketing, etc. "IAESTE" is an abbreviation for the International Association for the Exchange of Students for Technical Experience.

It aims to train engineers with a broad international perspective and has been active mainly in Europe since its foundation in the UK in 1948.

All internships are conducted in English.

Internships provide practical training in overseas laboratories or companies, making use of the expertise gained during/after university studies, and are different from study abroad programs where the aim is to learn English or to study a new specialization.

Students who submit their internship report within one month of completing their internship will be issued with an official IAESTE internship certificate. For more information, please visit the IAESTE Official Website (<https://iaeste.org>)

2. Glossary

Host institution: A company or university offering internship opportunities to students.

Offer: A prescribed format in which the host institution states the specialization and required skills of the student to be accepted, as well as the accommodation and accommodation to be provided. A sample INTERNSHIP OFFER (called O-Form, Form-O for short) issued by a host institution in Germany is shown on the next page.

Explanation of each item.

Ref. No. in the upper column: offer number. Country code (two letters of the alphabet) and a number.

Internship Host: Name, website and location of the host institution.

Student Required: field of specialization, required years of study, required language and level, required skills.

Internship Offer: possible duration of internship, estimated accommodation, accommodation and living costs, as well as job description, working environment and working hours.

You can choose the duration of your internship within the timeframe stated in Within Months (in weeks, for 8-12 you can choose the desired duration within the range of 8-12 weeks).

Deadline for Nomination: There is a deadline for applications.

Intern Candidate: A student who applied and successfully completed an interview with the IAESTE professor in charge. The right of an intern candidate to be an intern is valid as long as the student remains enrolled in a university in Japan.

IAESTE A.s.b.l.: A non-profit organization registered in the Grand Duchy of Luxembourg and the international umbrella organization for IAESTE. A.s.b.l. stands for "Association sans but lucrative."

Exchange Platform (EP): Offer publication and application system operated by IAESTE A.s.b.l. Initial registration is required to use the system. Through this system, host institutions, national IAESTE offices and students exchange documents.



SAMPLE

INTERNSHIP OFFER DE-2025-2067-2

Detmold, Germany

ON-SITE

INTERNSHIP HOST

 Name of Company
OWL University of Applied
Sciences and Arts - Technische
Hochschule Ostwestfalen-Lippe
Department 1

 Website
<https://www.th-owl.de/>

 Address of Company
Detmold
Germany

 Number of Employees
600

 Business or Product
Design, Architecture, Urban
Planning, Civil Engineering,
Traffic Engineering

STUDENT REQUIRED

 General Discipline
Architecture; Computer
Science /
Informatics; Environmental
Engineering/Sciences; Web
Development / Software
Engineering / Computer
Programming

Field of Study
General; General; General; General

Completed Years of Study
2

Language Required
English Good (B1, B2) Or
German Good (B1, B2)

Required Qualifications and Skills
R Programming Language | Python |
Microsoft Word | 3D Design | Acoustics
Candidates should possess a solid
disciplinary background related to at least
ONE of the following areas:
(1) Parametric Architectural Design -
Rhino and Grasshopper; (2)
Programming, statistical analysis,
machine learning - Python; (3) Virtual
Reality - video editing and post-processing
- Unity & similar; (4) Geographic
Information Systems (GIS) to work with
noise maps. We value individuals who
can demonstrate strong analytical skills,
effective communication

INTERNSHIP OFFER

 8 - 12
weeks

 992 EUR
per Month

 500 EUR
per Month

Latest Possible Start Date
01-May-2025

Within Months
Jul-2025 - Sep-2025

Company Closed Within
-

Deductions Expected
variable

Payment Method
Bank Transfer

Arranged by
IAESTE or on your own

Estimated Cost of Living including Lodging
992 EUR / Month

Working Environment: Research and development; Office
work

Working Hours / Week: 40.0

The Institute for Design Strategies (IDS) of the Detmold School of Design - TH OWL in Detmold, Germany is offering positions to support the research project "Building Acoustics and Urban Soundscape" focused on studying the relationship between building façades and people's perception of sound in cities.

The internship consists of supporting the research of human perception in cities, with a strong focus on sound and vision.

A successful candidate has experience in one or more of the areas required (Parametric design in Grasshopper / Statistics in Python / VR and game development / Noise mapping with GIS). A CV and portfolio showing the candidate's previous work is required. The internship is conducted in English.

www.th-owl.de/ids

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

see additional documents

Deadline for Nomination - 15-Mar-2025

3. Exchange system and matching

IAESTE Japan exchanges offers with other Member Countries on a one-to-one basis and matches the offers it obtains with pre-assumed intern candidates. Member countries that receive offers from IAESTE Japan also send students to host institutions in Japan. The mechanism that relies on this one-to-one exchange principle is called “Exchange Internship.”

On the other hand, there is also a mechanism for matching students through the EP, which does not rely on the exchange of offers and is called “Global Internship.”

Applicants who apply in April are only eligible for the Global Internship.

Note that “matching” merely indicates a stage before an intern candidate is accepted, and that the internship is only confirmed after the subsequent decision of the host institution.

4. The two types of offers and their characteristics

Exchange Internship (Not applicable for April applications and can only be applied for in September. The explanation below is for reference only)

IAESTE Japan contacts other Member countries to obtain offers that conform to the requirements of each intern candidate and matches one student per offer. If you are not accepted, you can continue your application for the Global Internship offer.

It is not permitted to reject a matched Exchange Internship offer and change to Global Internship. (Exceptions may be made if the country has been declared a travel risk).

◎Benefits

1. Offers are obtained on a case-by-case basis and there are no other applicants (competitors), so there is a significant chance that an internship will be confirmed.
2. Very high chance of being accepted if you have the necessary skills.

× Disadvantages

1. You cannot choose the country in which the internship takes place.
2. The details of the internship cannot be chosen, so the internship may not meet your expectations.
3. If there is no offer in the first-choice region that matches the desired field and desired duration, the second to fourth choice regions will be selected.

Global Internship (Only this offer type is available to applicants who applies in April)

The offers are published on the EP throughout the year and are viewable for intern candidates. If there are multiple applications for one offer, the most skilled student will be selected. Many offers close two weeks after publication, so nomination documents should be prepared promptly.

◎ Benefits.

1. You can select your own offers from the offers published on the EP by looking at the country of interest, internship content, duration of internship, etc. as far as you fulfil the necessary requirements stated in the offer.
You can apply for multiple offers (but not multiple offers in the same country at the same time)
2. You can find offers from internship hosts that do not appear on Exchange Internship.
3. If no students matching the requirements are found, the offer is repeatedly published in the system.

4. Many computer science offers are available.
5. Remote internships are also published.

× Disadvantages.

1. The number of offers varies depending on the time of year. Usually it is highest from April to June, declines in the summer months and then increases in autumn and winter.
2. Offers for students who completed 2 years of undergraduate studies, or who major in biology and urban planning are relatively scarce: Exchange Internships are recommended for such students.
3. Some offers may be highly competitive due to the large number of applications. Particularly competitive are offers from Switzerland, Austria and Scandinavia.

5. IAESTE Member Countries

Afghanistan, KU	Ghana	Philippines
Albania, SB	Greece	Poland
Argentina	Hungary	Qatar
Australia	India	Romania
Austria	Indonesia, UAJY	Russia
Azerbaijan, BIR	Iran	Serbia
Bangladesh	Iraq, UA	Slovakia
Belarus	Japan	Slovenia
Belgium	Jordan	Spain
Bolivia	Kazakhstan	Sri Lanka, UM
Bosnia and Herzegovina	Kenya	Sweden
Botswana, BIUST	Korea	Switzerland
Brazil	Kyrgyzstan, IntUIT	Syria
Cameroon, ELA	Lebanon	Tajikistan
Canada	Macedonia	Tanzania
Chile, TU	Malta	Thailand
China, BISC	Mexico, ITD	Tunisia
China Hong Kong	Mongolia	Turkey
China Macao	Nepal	Uganda, TIS
Colombia	Nicaragua, ULSA	United Arab Emirates
Croatia	Nigeria	United Kingdom
Czech Republic	Norway	United States
Ecuador	Oman	United States, PU
Egypt	Pakistan	United States, RH
France	Palestine	Uzbekistan
Gambia, MIMT	Panama	Vietnam, TNU
Germany	Peru	Yemen, HF

6. Trends in exchange numbers

Year	Students Sent	Students Received
2018	38	49
2019	44	50
2020	0	1 (Remote internship)
2021	12	0
2022	17	23
2023	33	34
2023	30	31
2025	32	32

Note: The decrease in 2020-2021 is due to travel and entry restrictions following the spread of Covid-19 infection.

II. Overview of IAESTE Internship

1. Field of internship

General science (including IT-related fields), business, marketing, etc. For more details, please refer to “V. List of fields of internship”.

2. Destination

Host institutions such as universities, research institutions or companies in IAESTE member countries.

Please note that there are few offers from North America and Oceania.

3. Duration of internship

For applicants applying in April 2026, the duration of internship is limited to within 1 June 2026 - 31 May 2027. If you wish to apply for internship after June 2026, please apply in September 2026.

The duration varies depending on the offer, ranging from 8 to 52 weeks, 8-12 weeks being the most common, followed by offers of six months and one year. **Please note that offers of more than six months are subject to strict criteria.**

Please note that in Germany, you can only choose a full duration of internship from the beginning of the month to the end of the month, meaning that you cannot start and end your internship on a date in the middle of the month. (e.g. internships from 1 July to 30 September are acceptable, but not from 13 July to 13 October).

4. Accommodation

In many cases, accommodation will be arranged by the host institution or the local IAESTE office.

5. Language

Internships are conducted in English. In non-English speaking countries, the native language of the country of internship may be required in everyday life, so it is advisable to learn some of the language of the country of internship once you have decided on your host country.

It is advantageous to have skills in the native language of the internship country: German language skills are an advantage in Austria, Switzerland and Germany.

6. Amount to be paid to the Japan Office

	University member students*1	Non-member school students	Students with IAESTE internship experience
Application fee	5,000 yen	10,000 yen	0 yen
Internship administration fee*2	50,000 yen	100,000 yen	Half of the amount shown on the left

*1: Current university members are the following 15 universities.

Osaka University, Okayama University, Kyoto University, Keio University, University of Tokyo, Institute of Science Tokyo, Tokyo Metropolitan University, Tokyo University of Agriculture and Technology, Tokyo University of Science, Doshisha University, Tohoku University, Muroran Institute of Technology, Yokohama National University, Ritsumeikan University, Waseda University

If you belong to a university member school at either the time of application or the time of internship, the amount for university member students will be applied.

*2: After applying and completing an interview with the IAESTE professor in charge, you will be registered as an intern candidate. Registration is valid during the period of enrolment.

The Internship administration fee for a remote internship is half the amount listed above.

7. Costs of internship

(1) Travel costs:

You are responsible for your own travel costs.

Airline tickets should be purchased after the visa has been granted.

(2) Accommodation expenses:

The amount indicated in the Payment section of the O-form will be paid. You may have to pay your own expenses for leisure time and holiday excursions.

(3) Overseas accident insurance:

Students are responsible for arranging their own insurance. Insurance is compulsory.

(4) Visa:

You are responsible for the cost of obtaining a visa.

If a visa is required for the country of internship, the host country's IAESTE will prepare the necessary documents for visa application. You must then apply for and obtain the visa yourself.

8. Requirements set by the host organization, etc.

(1) The host institution will examine your curriculum vitae (CV) and transcripts in English, so **you cannot apply for an offer that requires a field of study you have not completed.**

(2) If you wish to apply for internship in Architecture, you must have AutoCAD skills and submit a portfolio.

(3) Many host institutions in developed European countries require a minimum of 3-4 years of undergraduate completion, and many countries include a web or telephone interview during the acceptance screening process.

(4) In Switzerland, only master's degree students have the opportunity to do an internship. Also, since the visa application process takes approximately three months, please determine the start date with this timeframe in mind.

III. Flow up to the internship confirmation

For reference, the process after submitting an application is outlined briefly below. Please see the Internship Candidate Manual for further details.

1. Outline

- 1) Interview with the professor in charge of IAESTE at your university by the end of May to confirm the reason for your application, check your CV, etc. The results of the interview will be fed back to the Japan Office. The date of the interview will be decided after coordination with the professor in charge of the interview at each university.
Students of non-member universities will be interviewed by a professor from a member university.
- 2) Choose the offer you want from the EP. Inform the Japan Office of the reference number of the offer and transfer the internship administration fee at the same time.
- 3) After matching with the offer, the Japan office will submit the nomination documents by the deadline. However, if there are multiple applications for one offer, the Japan Office will select and match up to two people who are most suitable based on the stated conditions (skills, English ability, number of credits in the field of specialization, and transcripts).
- 4) Once your offer has been matched, **prepare the documents required for nomination according to the instructions on the EP screen and email them to the Japan Office as a single PDF file.** The Japan Office then checks to ensure that the nomination documents are in order exactly as instructed, uploads them to the EP and forwards them to the host country.
- 5) The host institution decides whether to accept or reject the nomination. It may conduct an online or telephone interview before this. You may not be accepted if the required knowledge, skills and language skills stated in the offer are not met.
As part of the selection process, the host institution may conduct an interview (online or by phone). In Austria, the IAESTE Austria office conducts an initial interview in English. For long-term internships of six months or more, an interview is mandatory, and a high level of professional expertise and English proficiency is required.
- 6) When you pass the host institution's decision, "Acceptance Notes" (acceptance letter) will be uploaded to the EP and you will be officially assigned as an intern.
If there are multiple applications for the offer you have selected, the host institution will screen your applications and you may be rejected. In that case, you will need to look for another offer and repeat steps 2) to 5) above.

IV. List of internship fields

IAESTE A.s.b.l. classifies the fields of study as shown in the table below; the Symbol column indicates a symbol for convenience. An asterisk (*) in the Fields of study column indicates that there are subdivisions in the table on the next page.

General Disciplines		
Item	Symbol	Fields of study
Agriculture	01.A	*
Food Science	01.B	*
Natural Resources and Conservation	03.A	
Environmental Engineering/Sciences	03.B	*
Forestry	03.C	
Geography	03.D	
Architecture	04.A	*
Landscape Architecture	04.C	
Interior Architecture	04.D	
Civil Engineering	14.B1	*
Geology	14.B2	
Geodesy / Survey Engineering	14.B3	
Mining and Mineral Engineering	14.B4	
Electrical Engineering	14.C1	*
Electronics Engineering	14.C2	
Power Engineering	14.C3	*
Computer Software/Hardware Engineering	14.C4	*
Telecommunications	14.C5	
Mechanical Engineering	14.D1	*
Mechatronics, Robotics and Automation	14.D2	*
Industrial Engineering / System Engineering	14.D3	
Process Engineering	14.D4	
Metallurgical Engineering	14.B5	
Aerospace, Aeronautical and Astronautical/Space Engineering	14.B6	
Naval and Marine Engineering	14.B7	
Computer Science / Informatics	11.A	*
Web Development / Software Engineering / Computer Programming	11.B	
Network Administration	11.C	
Cybersecurity	11.D	
Bioinformatics	11.F	
Biology	26.A	*
Biomedical Sciences	26.B	
Bioengineering/Biomedical Engineering	26.C	
Biotechnology	26.D	*
Biochemistry	26.E	
Microbiology	26.F	
Pharmaceutical Studies / Pharmacology	26.G	
Veterinary	26.H	
Mathematics and Statistics	27	
Physics and Physical Sciences	40	*
Chemistry and Chemical Engineering	40.C1	*
Material Engineering and Sciences	40.C2	*
Textile Sciences and Engineering	40.C3	
Petroleum Engineering	40.C4	
Communication, Journalism and Related Programs	09	*
Education	13	*
Psychology	42	
Economics, Business, Management and Marketing	45.52	*

Fields of Study

Note: The left column shows the General Disciplines symbol, for clarity of relationships.

01.A	General Applied Horticulture Plant Sciences	26.A	General Plant Sciences Computational Biology & Bioinformatics Evolutionary Biology Molecular Biology / Cell Biology Bioanalytics
01.B	General Food Technology and Processing Brewing Science Nutrition & Health	26.D	General Medical Biotechnology Industrial Biotechnology Environmental Biotechnology Marine Biotechnology
03.B	General Water Management Water Resources Engineering Sustainable and Renewable Energy Engineering	40	General Astrophysics Atomic/Molecular Physics/ Nanophysics Plasma and High Temperature Physics Nuclear Physics Optics/Optical Sciences Acoustics Theoretical and Mathematical Physics Experimental Physics/Applied Physics
04.A	General City/Urban, Community and Regional Planning	40.C1	General Polymer/Plastics Engineering Nanotechnology Analytical Chemistry Inorganic Chemistry Organic Chemistry
14.B1	General Geotechnical and Geoenvironmental Engineering Structural Engineering Transportation and Highway Engineering Water Resources Engineering Underground Engineering Construction Engineering	40.C2	General Polymer/Plastics Engineering Nanotechnology
14.C1	General Laser and Optical Engineering Embedded System	09	General Digital Communication and Media/Multimedia Public Relations and Advertising
14.C3	General Nuclear/Nuclear Power Engineering Sustainable and Renewable Energy Engineering Power Systems Engineering	13	General Language Education/Linguistics
14.C4	General Information Technology	45.52	General Economics Business Administration, Management and Operations International Business/Relations Accounting/ Finance Tourism and Travel Services Hotel/Motel Administration Human Resources Marketing Sales Logistics
14.D1	General Fluid Mechanics Biomechanical Engineering		
14.D2	General Biomechanical Engineering		
11.A	General Computer and Information Research Database Architecture Data Science Artificial Intelligence Data Mining and Analytics Machine Learning Cloud Computing		
11.B	General Web Development Software Engineering Web and Digital Design Special Effects and Animations (2D/3D) Computer Game Programming Web page/ Digital and Multimedia Management		

Updated in September 2024
Partial revision in October 2024
Replacement of Offer sample in December 2024
Replacement of Offer sample and other revision in March 2025
The application procedures have been relocated to the Application Manual in April 2026.

The International Association for the Exchange of Students for Technical Experience Japan

E-mail: office@iaeste.or.jp
URL: <https://iaeste.or.jp>
Opening Hours: Monday to Friday 10:00-17:30